

Spoken Tutorial on Introduction to APIs

Module	Module 3: An Introduction to Building with AI
Tutorial	1. Introduction to APIs
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is using an analogy. 2. Explain the purpose of an API key. 3. Identify components of an API request.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• What is an API? • What is an API Key? • Making an API Request • Crafting Effective AI Prompts
Meta Tags	API, AI, Artificial Intelligence, API Key, API Request, Prompting, Development, Integration, Web Services, Spoken Tutorial, Programming, Machine Learning
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Module 2: Introduction to Prompting

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Spoken Tutorial on Introduction to APIs	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on Introduction to APIs.
Learning Objectives	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is using an analogy. • Explain the purpose of an API key. • Identify components of an API request.
System Requirements	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisites	To follow this tutorial, you should have prior knowledge. Refer to Module 2: Introduction to Prompting.
What is an API? Think of it like a Restaurant Waiter.	What is an API ? It stands for Application Programming Interface . Think of it like a restaurant waiter. Your app is the restaurant customer. You want a dish from the kitchen, which is the AI model. You give your order, or prompt , to the waiter. The waiter, or API , takes your order to the kitchen. The kitchen prepares your dish. Then the waiter brings it back to you. The API acts as a messenger between your application and an AI model.

What is an API Key? Think of it like your Restaurant ID Card.	Now, what is an API key? Think of it like your restaurant ID card. An API key is a secret password. It identifies you as an authorized user. Just like an ID proves you can order food. Your API key verifies your identity. It ensures your interactions are secure and private. You need it with each API request.
Real-Life Example: Checking Weather on Your Phone	Let's see how this works in real life. Open any weather app on your phone. Tap the search bar to find a city. Type your city name and press search. Behind the scenes, the app sends a request to the API. The weather API fetches data from sources. It sends this data back to your app. You now see the weather forecast on your screen. This is an API in action!
Making an API Request: Placing Your Order	Making an API request is like placing your order. You send your instructions to the AI model. This 'order' has two main parts. First, your API key for authentication. This proves you are an authorized user. Second, your prompt or instruction. The API delivers this to the model. The model processes it and sends a response.
Demo: Vague Prompt Example	Let's look at a vague prompt example. Imagine you tell the AI model, 'Write a story'. This is a very general request. The AI will likely give you a generic story. It might be uninspired and not what you want.
Demo: Improved Prompt Example	Now, let's try an improved prompt. You could say, 'Write a short, exciting sci-fi story'. Add more details like, 'about a space explorer'. They discover a new alien species. This happens on a barren planet. This specific prompt guides the AI. It helps generate a more engaging story.
Demo: Vague vs. Improved Prompt Comparison	Let us compare the outputs. The vague prompt gave a generic story. The improved prompt gave a focused story. It resulted in a creative sci-fi adventure. This shows the power of specific requests. Clear details make a big difference.

Summary	Let us summarize what we learned. We defined APIs using the waiter analogy. We understood API keys as identification. We explored API request components. We also saw the impact of prompt quality.
Assignment	Now as an assignment, identify an API in another app you use daily. Think about what the 'request' might be. Also consider what 'response' the app receives. Compare the results.
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